

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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International Baccalaureate®
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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a **reflective statement** of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.

By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

I have chosen 1984 by George Orwell, a novel with multiple possible analytical avenues. I have narrowed these down to only two, that with further research will shape my thesis question and focus for the essay. I could have explored George Orwell's expression of identity through this novel, as I had multiple sources through which I have gained insight into his life and various aspects that shaped him as a person. Alternatively, a dive into his utilisation of this novel as a means to communicate an intended message was also a possible focus for my essay. I ultimately formulated and used the research question - "How does Orwell use setting to communicate the dangers of a totalitarian society?" This topic is important because Orwell's work not only critiques the totalitarian society within the novel but also looks forward to how our contemporary world could suffer from some of the consequences: the novel is currently relevant. After writing my 2,000-word draft, with a planned outline and chosen sections to analyse from the novel itself, I realised some of the challenges I faced, especially regarding structural progression of my argument itself. Therefore I believed that some research from a critical and biographical perspective would help improve my understanding and production of my analysis, in turn improving the cohesiveness and the depth of understanding I have. For structural improvement, I used a thematic progression of sanctuary, compromise of home, and power. I also made sure that I had a range of sources that were appropriate. Lastly, I also explored Orwell's personal context behind the production of this novel in order to better link my analysis to the novel itself. After submitting the essay, I believe that this was a satisfying project for me, analysing a complex cesspool of ideas like 1984 from an interesting analytical perspective, thus learning the intricacies of time management and critical thinking experientially too. Working on this was not a linear process, as it required a great deal of thought and carefully crafting my ideas appropriately, something I found challenging. I thus worked in chunks, often struggling with the vast workload of my other schoolwork too. However, things clicked in place for me mentally after the feedback on my first draft, as I gained insight into precise ways to improve, thus changing various aspects of my essay. The structure, use of researched sources, and the tone of my conclusion were all modified to create a more holistic and clear communication of my analytical deductions from the work. The essay looked radically different to my initial vision - continual prose of analysis with an intro and conclusion, finishing instead as a systematically organised piece with many sections. This reflects the evolution of my thinking through this novel experience of working on a project of this magnitude from a language standpoint. I was able to transfer the research, critical thinking, and writing skills to my university classes and also to other facets of my life--in my future job, for instance.